

Signal of the week

Kigen wins first GSMA eSA certification for SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM

Arm's Kigen unit earned GSMA SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM certification, paired with Infineon's TEGRION SLI22. OEM sampling in ETSI MFF2 begins October 2026; China Mobile International is connectivity partner.

Why it matters — Sets the reference eSIM stack competing directly with Cubic³ orchestration for long-life vehicle fleets.

Sources: Kigen press release (media-outreach.com) (2026-09-29) · IoT Business News (2026-09-29)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect- ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins	Regu- latory	Cyber- security	Quality	Telematics services
Automotive	3	2	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
Robotics / AV	4	0	4	1	0	0	0	0	0
Fleets	1	3	2	3	0	0	0	0	0
Energy	2	2	1	3	0	0	0	0	0
Agri / industrial	1	0	3	1	0	0	0	0	0

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6), by theme: none 1-2 3-5 6+

The read-across

Regulation is the through-line this week. The EU Data Act's design-by-default duties applied from 12 September, and by month-end Wialon, High-Mobility and Flespi were shipping OEM-native data pipelines to fleets. Six of 18 qualified items touch a named Cubic³ account.

The heat-map shows SDV and AI concentrating in automotive and robotics, whilst data and connectivity dominate fleets and energy. Kigen's SGP.32 v1.3 eSIM certification, Elli's commercial V2G launch and SoftBank's October GPU cloud go-live mark a week in which orchestration layers hardened across five domains.

75

candidates screened

16

items featured

8

deals logged

● Automotive OEMs

Data mgmt SDV

EU Data Act design-by-default duties bite on connected vehicles

EU Data Act design-by-default obligations applied from 12 September 2026, requiring connected vehicle makers to embed real-time third-party data access. Direct user access must be free; B2B sharing follows FRAND compensation rules.

So what — Every European connected car sold from now must ship with open data access as standard.

vxlabs.ai regulatory brief, 2026-09-12 · Mordor Intelligence / marqstats.com, 2026-09-18

SDV AI

SoundHound launches on-device agentic voice AI for vehicles

SoundHound unveiled OASYS Edge on 24 September 2026, an embedded LLM voice system running agentic reasoning fully on-device. Automotive deployment is due late 2026, with CES 2027 demonstrations across cloud, edge and hybrid environments.

So what — Shifts cockpit AI inference from cloud to edge, reducing dependence on cellular data pipes.

SoundHound Investor Newsroom, 2026-09-24

Connectivity SDV

Tata Communications embeds MOVE into Tata Motors N.IO SDV platform

Tata Communications embedded its MOVE Connected Vehicle Platform into Tata Motors' N.IO SDV architecture, delivering built-in 5G to the Sierra.ev SUV. The integration supports OTA, remote diagnostics, emergency call, in-cabin streaming and subscription management.

So what — In-house telco-OEM stack replaces external orchestration for Tata's SDV programme.

Autocar Pro India, 2026-08-25

● Robotics and autonomous vehicles

AI SDV

Wayve signs Nissan, Uber and Mercedes-Benz for AI autonomy

Wayve partnered with Nissan and Uber to launch a Tokyo robotaxi service combining Wayve's AI with Nissan ProPilot, and separately signed Mercedes-Benz to embed its stack in Mercedes SDV platforms.

So what — Positions Wayve as the leading independent autonomy licensor across three major OEM programmes.

TechCrunch Mobility, 2026-09-27 · AV Market Strategist (Substack), 2026-09-28

AI SDV Data mgmt

Uber commits \$10bn to AVs with Rivian and Avride deals

Uber announced roughly \$10bn in AV investment, including \$7.5bn for fleet procurement and a Rivian deal for 10,000 robotaxis, with an option for 50,000 by 2030. The Waymo partnership unwinds by 2028; Avride and Motional cover Dallas and Las Vegas.

So what — Reshapes the robotaxi supply chain with Uber owning fleet capital rather than platform rides.

Smart Cities Dive (citing FT), 2026-09-22

SDV AI

NHTSA opens audit into Tesla Cybercab safety self-certification

NHTSA opened Audit Query AQ26002 on 3 September 2026 into Tesla's self-certification that the Cybercab meets Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards after it entered paid public service in Austin. The Cybercab has no steering wheel or pedals.

So what — First federal audit of a supervisorless robotaxi tests the limits of self-certification.

NHTSA record via Tesla Robotaxi article, 2026-09-03

● Fleets

Data mgmt Connectivity

Wialon opens OEM-native vehicle data to fleets via High-Mobility and Flespi

Wialon established a data pipeline via High-Mobility and Flespi, giving fleet owners direct, warranty-safe OEM vehicle data without aftermarket hardware, framed as an EU Data Act compliance response.

So what — Removes the aftermarket dongle from fleet telematics for EU operators using Wialon.

Work Truck Online, 2026-09-09

AI Connectivity

SoftBank launches NVIDIA GB200 AI data-centre GPU cloud in October

SoftBank is launching its AI Data Centre GPU Cloud in October 2026 using NVIDIA GB200 NVL72 systems in Japanese data centres, integrated with its mobile network as distributed AI-RAN infrastructure.

So what — Gives SoftBank a native latency-sensitive AI hosting layer adjacent to its mobile network.

TelecomLead, 2026-09-30

SDV AI Data mgmt

Google Cloud and Valtech build Nexus SDV platform on Bigtable

Google Cloud partner Valtech detailed Nexus SDV, linking AAOS in-vehicle services to fleet telemetry in Google Bigtable. Continuous materialised views pre-compute fleet-wide metrics such as battery temperature and torque distribution.

So what — Puts Google's SDV stack directly against orchestration incumbents for OEM fleet telemetry.

Google Cloud Blog (Japanese), 2026-07-29

● Energy

SDV Data mgmt

VW's Elli launches commercial V2G package in Germany

Elli commercially launched its V2G package in Germany — a DC bidirectional charger, Volkswagen Naturstrom V2G Flow tariff and Elli BiDi App — targeting around 360,000 V2G-ready vehicles. ID. Software 6 OTA extends compatibility beyond the 77 kWh threshold.

So what — First European OEM to package V2G hardware, tariff and app as a retail bundle.

Elli / Volkswagen Group Newsroom, 2026-10-01

SDV Connectivity

GM commits all future EVs to V2G and ISO 15118 standards

GM committed to V2G capability across all planned future EV models. Its current fleet of around 250,000 V2G-capable vehicles could power 120,000 homes for a week. ISO 15118 is the cited communication framework.

So what — Locks in bidirectional charging across GM's future range using an open communication standard.

GM Newsroom, 2026-06-09

AI Data mgmt

ELECTRA AI files updated SEC prospectus for Nasdaq battery-intelligence SPAC

ELECTRA AI and Iron Horse Acquisition II filed an updated Form 425 detailing a multi-terawatt-hour BESS pipeline built on agentic AI and physics-informed battery modelling. The combined company expects to list on Nasdaq as AIBR in H2 2026.

So what — Creates the first pure-play listed AI battery-intelligence company for grid-scale storage.

U.S. SEC EDGAR (Form 425), 2026-10-01

● Agri and industrial OEMs

AI SDV

Applied Intuition launches Dana agentic AI platform with Komatsu

Applied Intuition launched Dana, an agentic AI platform unifying data curation, simulation, training, evaluation and deployment for safety-critical machines. Komatsu received early access for mining autonomy, with development cycles reportedly 20× faster.

So what — Places Komatsu on a shared autonomy toolchain with automotive and defence customers.

Automotive World, 2026-07-21

AI Data mgmt

John Deere unveils JD AI Assistant at Farm Progress Show

John Deere unveiled its JD AI Assistant at Farm Progress Show 2026, an AI copilot analysing field, machine and operational data. Rivals PTx Trimble and CNH rely on API-driven telemetry hubs linked to Raven Slingshot and AFS Connect.

So what — Puts a native Deere copilot against telematics-hub rivals for mixed-fleet farm data.

AgriTech Magazine, 2026-09-28

AI

Hitachi to launch GENIAC-backed Physical AI project for autonomous excavators

Hitachi Construction Machinery will begin the GENIAC R&D project in October 2026, developing Physical AI trained on skilled-operator footage and lever logs for excavators. The collaboration with Jizai Inc. targets disaster recovery, construction and mining.

So what — Aligns Japanese public funding with excavator autonomy training on operator behaviour data.

Heavy Equipment Magazine, 2026-09-21

● Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
Wayve	Nissan, Uber, Mercedes-Benz	Tokyo robotaxi launch and Mercedes SDV integration	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Arm Kigen	Infineon, China Mobile International	First SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM certified, OEM sampling Oct 2026	Automotive	Competitive
Uber	Rivian	10,000 robotaxis, option to 50,000 by 2030 (~\$10bn)	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Wialon	High-Mobility, Flespi	Native OEM data pipeline for fleet operators	Fleets	Partner
Elli	Volkswagen Group brands	Commercial V2G bundle launch across Germany	Energy	Prospect
SoftBank	NVIDIA	GB200 NVL72 AI GPU cloud launch, October 2026	Fleets	SoftBank
Applied Intuition	Komatsu	Dana agentic AI early-access partnership for mining autonomy	Agri / industrial	Customer
ELECTRA AI	Iron Horse Acquisition II Corp	SPAC merger, Nasdaq listing as AIBR H2 2026	Energy	Competitive

Watch list

Verizon Connect finds AI video telematics adoption at 46%. Video AI has crossed from early adopter to mainstream fleet telematics feature.

Method: 75 candidates screened across ~60 sources for the week; items scored 0–10 on significance, novelty and relevance; threshold 6. Themes: SDV, connectivity, AI, data management, digital twins, regulatory framework, cybersecurity, quality and telematics services. Full source list in editions/ on GitHub.